



Hana Awad

User Experience Designer & ex Architect

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Passionate interface and UX designer with front end development experience and an architect's background. I take products from research and information architecture through to designed, shipped interfaces, and because I also write front end code, I design with the grain of what's buildable. Ex architect from Alexandria, Egypt, now based in Copenhagen.

STRENGTHS & WORKING STYLE



Hard worker. I take ownership from first research to shipped product, and I follow through.



Love to negotiate. I enjoy finding the middle ground between user needs, business goals, and engineering constraints to reach decisions the team can commit to.



Problem solver. I like untangling messy, ambiguous problems and turning them into clear, buildable solutions.



Always curious. I love learning how things work, and I pick up new tools, domains, and codebases quickly.



Architect's eye. A background in structure, proportion, and detail that shapes how I approach UX and information.

EXPERIENCE

■ Senior UX Designer Lead

Apr 2021 – Present

SOUNDBOKS · Copenhagen, Denmark

- Led the end to end UX for Lightboks, SOUNDBOKS's first light and a new product category, from concept, research and the colour and control systems through to the shipped companion app, validated through internal, external and real world party testing.
- Translate insights and business requirements into product design concepts and intuitive end to end experiences.
- Lead UX design strategy from start to finish, with deep research, creative ideation, and tackling design strategy and information architecture challenges across the whole UX journey.
- Develop user centric brand experiences across online shops, digital products, and services; build customer journeys, sketches and wireframes.
- Lead research projects and develop new app features through cross team collaboration with stakeholders across departments.
- Build a Figma component library and design frameworks for website and mobile app, improving UI consistency and speed of delivery.
- Work with scalable, responsive designs; collaborate with Product Owners and Engineers from conception to launch in an agile, weekly sprint process.

■ UX Designer & Frontend Developer

Aug 2018 – Present

Ovni · Egypt

- Developed user personas and user journeys, and defined the product roadmap and KPIs to prioritise work.
- Fast sketching and prototyping; designed website and mobile app frameworks in Figma for back end developers.
- Implemented designs using the Angular framework, working weekly with back end developers on the high level experience and key interactions.
- Worked with the marketing team to understand market traction and strengthen community building.

■ UX Designer & Frontend Developer

Sep 2019 – Aug 2020

Memorix · Copenhagen, Denmark

- Weekly user testing plus desk and on site research to understand user challenges and the market domain.
- Developed personas and journeys; defined the product roadmap and KPIs.
- Designed website and mobile app frameworks in Figma and implemented designs using Angular, working daily with back end developers.

■ Frontend Web Developer Intern

Jul 2019 – Sep 2019

Valuer · Copenhagen, Denmark

- Redesigned proposals for Valuer's website; produced ebook and thumbnail designs.

■ Full Stack & Web Developer Intern

Mar 2019 – Sep 2019

Bomae · Copenhagen, Denmark

- Built a customised CRM to meet business requirements, giving full visibility on cases and easier document sharing with customers.
- Designed and implemented the dashboard, improving employee productivity.

■ Interior Designer (Freelance)

Jul 2016 – Sep 2018

Freelance · Egypt · Zurich · Copenhagen

- Delivered residential apartment, villa and office projects, including client consultation, schematic design, 3D visualisation, detailed drawings and final delivery.

■ Architect, Researcher & Teaching Assistant

Jul 2014 – Sep 2018

Arab Academy for Science & Technology (AAST) · Alexandria, Egypt

- Organised and developed teaching material for university lectures; reviewed material with students in group and one to one sessions.
- Assisted in preparing examinations and grading student progress and projects.

EDUCATION

MSc, Architectural Engineering & Environmental Design

Sep 2017 – Aug 2019

Arab Academy for Science & Technology (AAST) · Alexandria, Egypt

Graduated with honours. Thesis: a sustainable design approach studying natural ventilation in educational buildings.

BSc, Architectural Engineering & Environmental Design

Sep 2009 – Aug 2014

Arab Academy for Science & Technology (AAST) · Alexandria, Egypt

Front End Web Development Nanodegree

Jan 2020

Udacity · Online

Web Development Bootcamp

Jan 2019

Le Wagon · Copenhagen, Denmark

9 week full stack bootcamp: Ruby, Ruby on Rails, JavaScript, HTML & CSS, APIs, GitHub, Heroku, plus an introduction to UX design and Figma.

Parametric Design Course

Sep 2014

Architectural Association · Berlin, Germany

Sustainability Summer School

Jul 2011

University of Lincoln · Lincoln, UK

CERTIFICATIONS

LinkedIn Learning · Jan 2021

Analyzing User Data

Creating Personas

Ideation

Creating Scenarios & Storyboards

Implementation Planning

Prototyping

Multidevice Design

SKILLS

UX / UI

Figma

Adobe XD

InVision

Whimsical

Sketching

Wireframing

Prototyping

Usability testing

Photoshop

Illustrator

InDesign

Front end & software

HTML

CSS

JavaScript

Angular

Bootstrap

Ruby

Ruby on Rails

Git

Heroku

Linux

OOP

SaaS

Architecture

Autodesk Revit 2D/3D

Autodesk 3D MAX

SketchUp

AutoCAD

3D visualisation & rendering

Schematic design

Technical drawing

Design research

Project planning

Parametric design

Sustainable design

Spatial & systems thinking

Ways of working

Agile / Scrum

Information architecture

Customer journeys

Cross team collaboration

LANGUAGES

Arabic

Native

English

Fluent

Danish

Learning (module 3)

French

Beginner